CHAPTER 2

Preliminary Notes



This chapter is part of the PINK and GOLD reading tours. See Figure 1-1 in Chapter 1, Section 1.3, for alternative reading tours.

To fully understand and appreciate the TOGAF Standard, some background information is necessary. It is essential to know the origins of the world's leading architecture framework as this helps to form a complete picture of the evolution that the TOGAF Standard has gone through and the moments in time that determined the growth of the framework.

The emergence of architecture frameworks has been the catalyst for the creation and evolution of the TOGAF Standard as we know it today.

This chapter discusses the development of the TOGAF Standard and its subsequent evolution in detail.

2.1. A Brief History

Enterprise Architecture emerged in the 1960s and 1970s as large organizations began to see the need for more formal methods of managing their complex (IT) systems and aligning them with business goals and intended outcomes. At that time, several attempts were made to develop system architectures and information models.

© Eric Jager 2025
E. Jager, *Mastering the TOGAF® Standard*, https://doi.org/10.1007/979-8-8688-1814-1_2

In the 1980s, the term Enterprise Architecture began to take hold. At that time, the focus was on defining and documenting the structure and components of an organization's information systems. The primary focus lay at the intersection of IT and information delivery. During this decade, methodologies such as John Zachman's Framework for Enterprise Architecture emerged. Enterprise Architecture has evolved in response to the increasing complexity of IT environments and related business processes.

The Zachman Framework (actually an *ontology*) was published by John Zachman in 1987 [4]. It was the first framework to focus on structuring IT infrastructure and business processes.

During the 1990s, the Zachman Framework became increasingly popular as an Enterprise Architecture methodology. The framework was used by many organizations, including government agencies and other large corporations. The framework underwent several revisions to better meet the changing needs of organizations.

The 1990s marked a period of increasing interest and growth in the field of Enterprise Architecture. More and more organizations recognized the importance of aligning IT with their business goals. In 1995, The Open Group introduced what is now called the TOGAF Standard, which provided a comprehensive approach to Enterprise Architecture.

In the early 2000s, more emphasis was placed on the integration of IT and business strategies, leading to the adoption of Enterprise Architecture as a strategic management discipline. Enterprise Architecture frameworks and methodologies, such as the Zachman Framework and the TOGAF Standard, became more widely accepted and used. In the mid- to late 2000s, Enterprise Architecture evolved to address the complexity of globalized and networked organizations. The focus shifted to a more holistic approach to Enterprise Architecture that included not only IT systems, but also business processes, people, and organizational structures. This broader perspective was necessary to adapt to rapidly changing market dynamics and technological innovations.

The evolution of Enterprise Architecture brought a new level of focus to the strategic importance of IT within organizations. It became a way to align IT infrastructure and business processes with business goals, thereby increasing the value of IT. Enterprise Architecture also offered a way to manage and reduce the complexity of IT environments, thereby reducing the cost and risk of IT projects.

The evolution of today's leading architectural frameworks, starting with the introduction of the Zachman Framework, is shown in Figure 2-1.

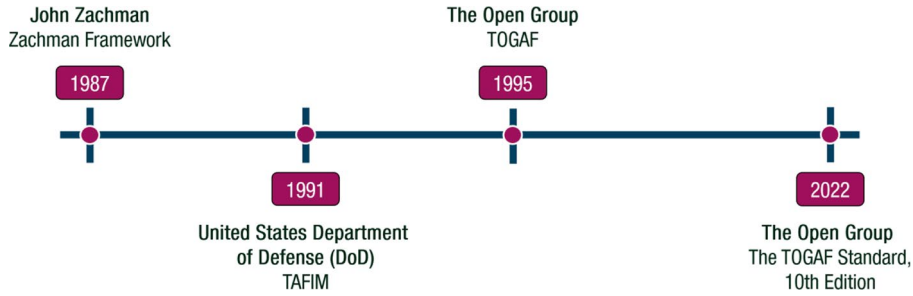


Figure 2-1. *The evolution of today's leading architecture frameworks*

Shortly after 2000, the Zachman Framework was further developed, extended, and adapted to the changing needs of organizations. More attention was given to the relationship between Enterprise Architecture and digital transformation, and new tools and techniques were developed to support Enterprise Architecture modeling. Of course, the Zachman Framework has also been criticized, and the applicability and practical value of the framework and its role in an ever-changing IT environment have been debated.

Throughout the 2010s, Enterprise Architecture became increasingly aligned with other strategic management disciplines, such as business process management, data management, and enterprise security. Enterprise Architecture evolved into an essential tool for guiding digital transformation initiatives, cloud adoption, and agile development practices.

In recent years, the profession has evolved in response to the increasing significance of digitization, data-driven decision-making, and emerging technologies, including artificial intelligence, the Internet of Things (IoT), and blockchain. Enterprise Architecture has become more adaptive and agile in order to address the dynamic and rapidly changing business landscape.

Today, organizations use this discipline to optimize business processes and IT infrastructure, accelerate digital transformation, and strengthen their competitive position. Enterprise Architecture continues to evolve and adapt to the ever-changing technological environment and business needs. Throughout its history, the discipline has evolved from primarily IT-focused to *strategic and business-centric*.



Further Reading

Additional information about the Zachman Framework in the form of the document "A Framework for Information Systems Architecture" can be found at the following URL:

https://www.academia.edu/30793320/A_framework_for_information_systems_architecture

The development of the Zachman Framework is detailed in a document available at this URL:

https://zachman-feac.com/the-zachman-framework-evolution

2.2. The Evolution of the TOGAF Standard

Today, the TOGAF Standard – the world's leading architecture framework – consists of several components, including an Architecture Development Method (ADM), a set of standards, and a set of tools and techniques. The

TOGAF Standard is designed to help organizations develop a holistic and integrated Enterprise Architecture that is aligned with their business objectives.

Looking at the evolution of the TOGAF Standard over the years, the framework has evolved from an enhanced version of the Technical Architecture Framework for Information Management (TAFIM) framework to a full-fledged Enterprise Architecture framework.

2.2.1. The Early Versions

Back in 1995, the first edition of what is now known as the TOGAF Standard was published under the name of the *Open Architecture Framework*. This name was initially changed to The Open Group Architecture Framework with the same speed with which it was coined. Later, it was decided to use only the original acronym in conjunction with the word *standard*: the TOGAF Standard. The very first version of the framework (see Figure 2-2) served as a *proof of concept*. It was the result of a *proof of need* from a year earlier (1994).

Because The Open Group was committed to an annual release cycle in the early years, TOGAF 2.0 appeared in 1996. The first edition's proof of concept was transformed into a *proof of application*.

In 1997, prompted by the annual release schedule, version 3.0 appeared. The purpose of this release was to reaffirm its relevance to practical architectures. The following years saw the release of TOGAF 4 and 5 in 1998 and 1999, respectively.

The fourth edition of the architecture framework offered the ability to access content via the Internet, which at the time led to a significant increase in the number of users of the Standard.

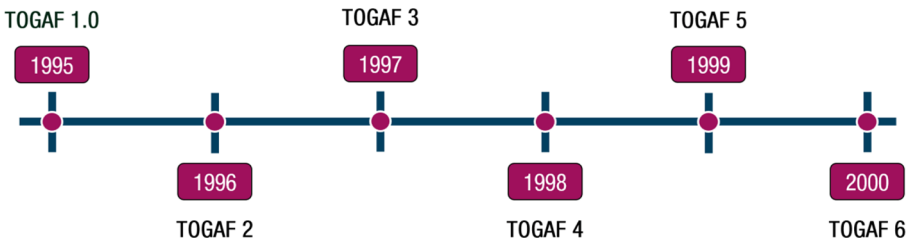


Figure 2-2. *The early versions of the TOGAF Standard throughout the years*

TOGAF 5 was largely rewritten to focus more on the refined and expanded Architecture Development Method.

In 2000, TOGAF 6 was released, with The Open Group doing a lot of work to incorporate building blocks into the framework (see Chapter 7, Section 7.5.2).

2.2.2. The More Recent Versions

When TOGAF 7 was released in 2001, it was given a subtitle. The term *Technical Edition* was added to the name of the framework.

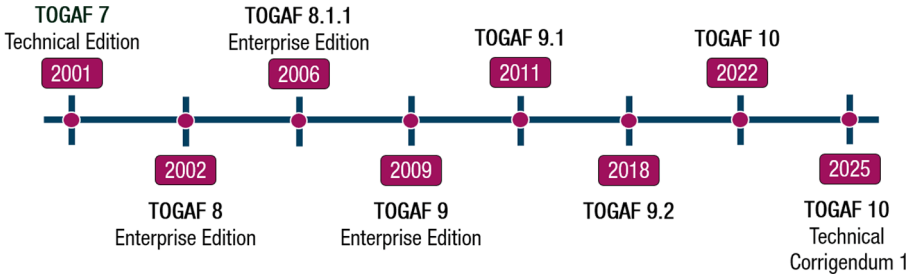


Figure 2-3. *The more recent versions of the TOGAF Standard throughout the years*

Given that there are still many architects (and non-architects) who deliberately refer to the TOGAF Standard as an IT framework, it may well be that this idea originated with the seventh edition of TOGAF.

The seventh edition of this well-known framework had been extensively updated (see Figure 2-3). This version provided a more structured approach to Enterprise Architecture, including guidance on architecture development, the Architecture Development Method, and architecture views. The Business Scenarios topic also received a significant update with additional material. Finally, a section comparing the framework to other architectural frameworks had been included. Meanwhile, the TOGAF Framework consisted of a more elaborate Architecture Development Method, a Foundation Architecture, and a Resource Base.

The Foundation Architecture, shown in Figure 2-4, consisted of a Technical Reference Model, a Standards Information Base, and a Building Block Information Base.

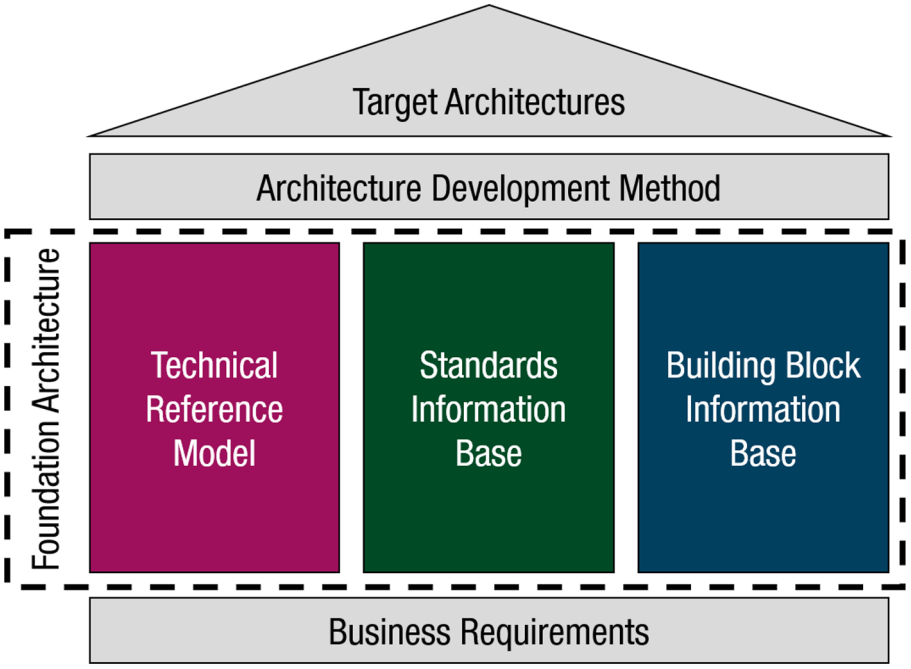


Figure 2-4. *The Foundation Architecture in context of the framework*

The Resource Base included advice on architecture views, architecture governance, business scenarios, Architecture Principles, and additional reference models. Today, the Resource Base can be compared to the TOGAF Library (see Chapter 3, Section 3.4).

The revised version of the Architecture Development Method played an increasingly important role in the development of the framework. Where the very first version of the TOGAF Standard used the TAFIM framework, slowly but surely the contours of the Architecture Development Method as we know it today began to emerge (see Figure 2-5).

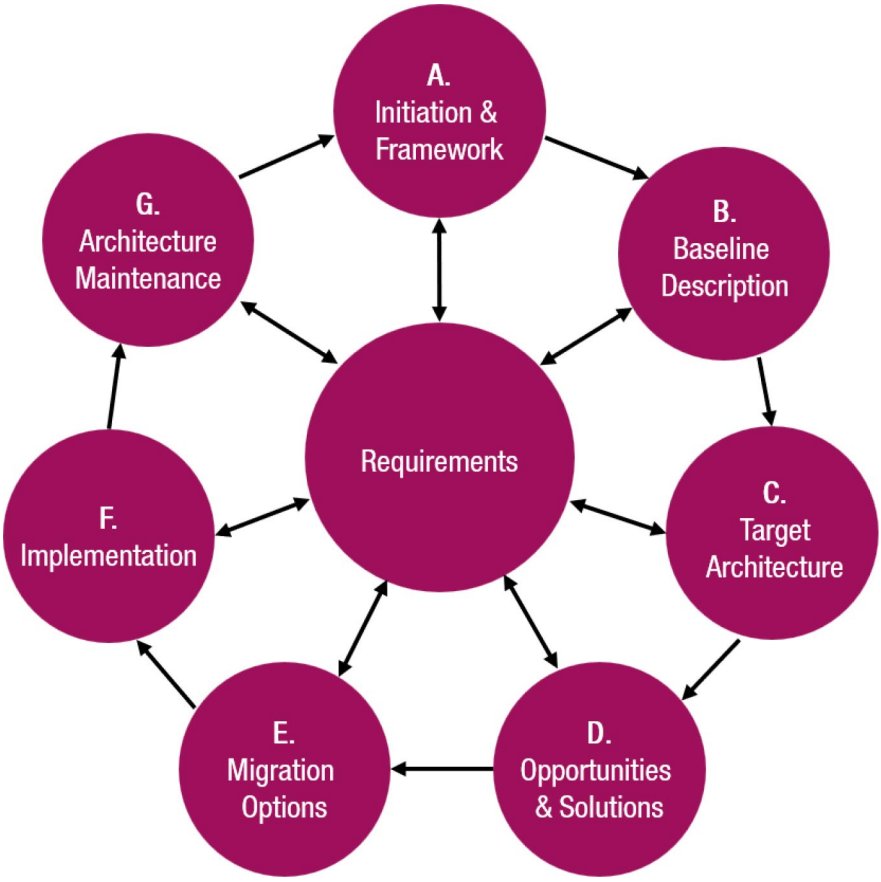


Figure 2-5. *The Architecture Development Method in TOGAF 7 (2001)*

One year after the publication of the seventh edition, another edition was released. TOGAF 8 saw the light of day in 2002. This version expanded on the framework's capabilities for broader Enterprise Architecture applications.

Remarkably, after a year of working with the Technical Edition subtitle, it was already abandoned. The subtitle *Enterprise Edition* was quickly added, hoping to rapidly wipe out the memory of the Technical Edition. This turned out to be a futile hope.

Today, more than two decades after the release of TOGAF 8, the framework is still often associated with the technical origins with which it began. The question, of course, is whether the addition of the words "*Technical Edition*" actually caused this.

Undoubtedly, it did not help.

In the eighth edition of the TOGAF Standard, the now familiar Preliminary Phase was added to the Architecture Development Method. This is illustrated in Figure 2-6. At the time, this phase was called Preliminary Framework and Principles. The other phases were given the names they still carry today.



Figure 2-6. *The Architecture Development Method in TOGAF 8 (2002)*

A year before the release of version 8.1.1, TOGAF became a registered trademark of The Open Group. TOGAF 8.1.1 became available in 2006, and this release was also subtitled Enterprise Edition. The last version to carry

the suffix was version 9, released in 2009. All versions of the framework released after version 9 had to do without a subtitle.

The transition from TOGAF 8 to TOGAF 9 was considered revolutionary. It brought significant updates, including a modular structure and more detailed guidance on the Architecture Development Method and Architecture Content Framework. Starting with version 9, the Architecture Content Framework was introduced, connecting all the artifacts in the framework. The Architecture Repository also saw the light of day with version 9.

It is interesting to note that the Business Architecture domain was not significantly expanded until TOGAF version 9.2.

Prior to version 9.2, this domain was described very briefly, and architects had to make do with references to other bodies of knowledge.

Version 9.2 of the framework was released in 2018, some nine years after the release of TOGAF 9.

The TOGAF Standard, 10th Edition, represents a significant update to the framework. Released in 2022, it is the first version of the TOGAF Framework to have the word *Standard* added to it. The tenth edition leverages other available frameworks and bodies of knowledge on many fronts. A good example of this is in the area of Business Architecture. Where the TOGAF Standard made an effort to add substance to it with version 9.2, and attempted to incorporate the domain of Business Architecture, the publication of version 10 has again made reference to other bodies of knowledge. For example, the framework now refers to the Business Architecture Body of Knowledge (BIZBOK) Guide [5] - maintained by the Business Architecture Guild - for information on and application of the Business Architecture domain. These references appear in a number of Series Guides.

A Technical Corrigendum was published on May 15, 2025. This document included updates to the TOGAF Standard, consisting mostly of textual adjustments and further clarifications. One significant change brought about by the Technical Corrigendum was the removal of all arrowheads from the Architecture Development Method (see Figure 2-7). This change was intended to further emphasize the iterative nature of the approach.

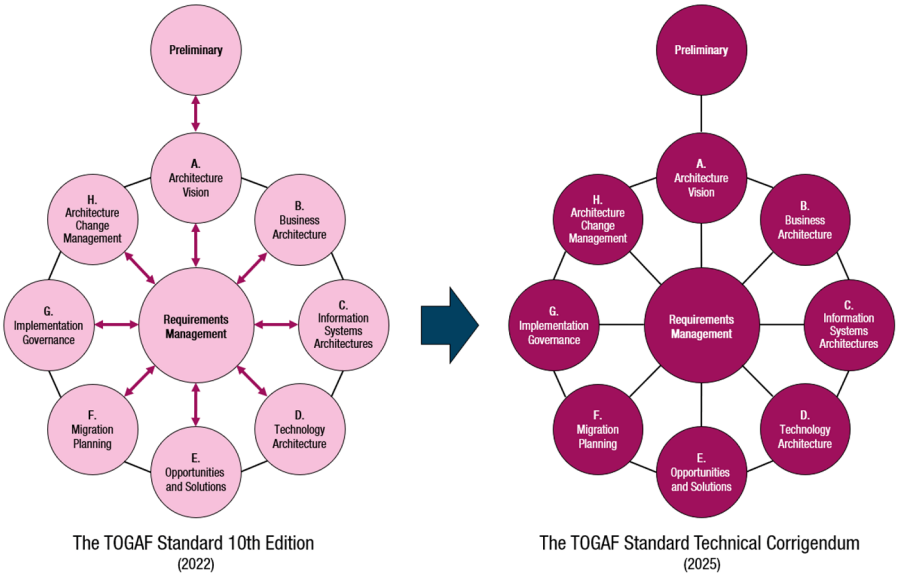


Figure 2-7. *The Architecture Development Method with and without arrowheads*

The TOGAF Standard aims to enhance the flexibility, usability, and accessibility of the framework for Enterprise Architects. It continues to evolve, with newer versions being developed to address modern Enterprise Architecture challenges. The focus has shifted to ensuring alignment between business and IT, incorporating agile methodologies, and supporting digital transformation initiatives.



Further Reading
Additional information about the TOGAF Standard version 7 can be found at the following URL:

https://www.opengroup.org/architecture/togaf7-doc/arch/

2.2.3. Comparison of TAFIM and TOGAF

As noted in the previous paragraphs, the TOGAF Standard owes its origins to the TAFIM framework. A very early version of the Architecture Development Method can be seen on the left of Figure 2-8. This left image comes from the 1996 TAFIM framework on which the TOGAF Standard is originally based. In the TAFIM model, all the phases that now make up the Architecture Development Method are already visible, even if they have different names. The phases have been expanded and further developed over the years. A visualization of the Architecture Development Method from the 2025 TOGAF Standard, 10th Edition Technical Corrigendum 1, is shown on the right.

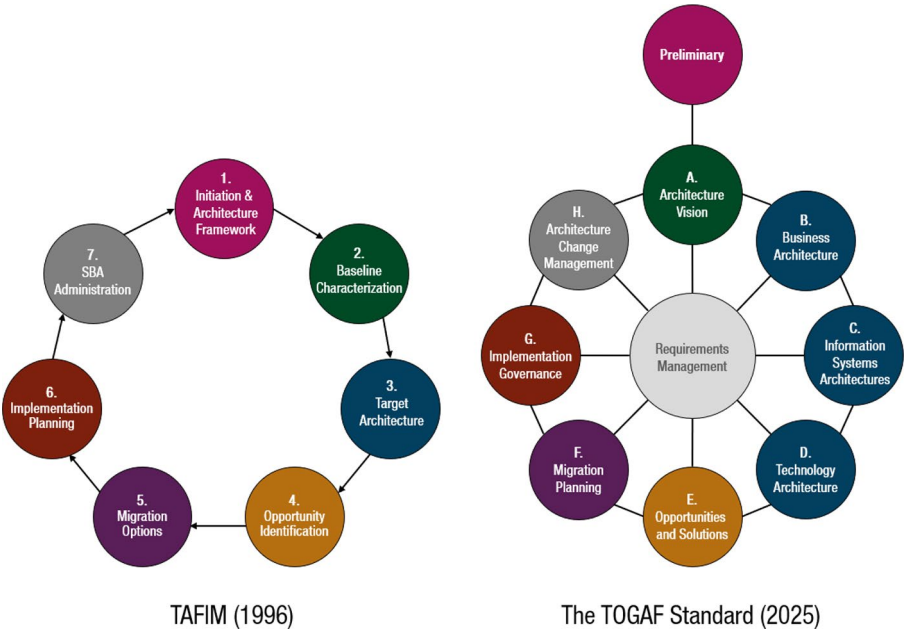


Figure 2-8. *Phases of TAFIM and TOGAF ADM mapped*

The phases in the TAFIM framework are logically similar to the phases in TOGAF's Architecture Development Method. Table 2-1 illustrates this mapping.

Table 2-1. *Mapping of the TAFIM and TOGAF ADM Phases*

TAFIM Framework Phase	TOGAF ADM Phase
Initiation and Architecture Framework	Preliminary Phase
Baseline Characterization	Architecture Vision
Target Architecture	Business Architecture Information Systems Architectures Technology Architecture
Opportunity Identification	Opportunities and Solutions
Migration Options	Migration Planning
Implementation Planning	Implementation Governance
SBA Administration	Architecture Change Management

It is worth noting that the third phase of the TAFIM framework was changed during the development of the TOGAF Standard. What is called *Target Architecture* in the TAFIM framework has been divided into three separate phases in the Architecture Development Method. These phases are known as Business Architecture, Information Systems Architectures, and Technology Architecture.

Over the years, the TOGAF Standard has always treated these three separate phases as truly distinct phases. However, with the advent of the tenth edition, you can see a further shift toward bringing the three phases more together.

The description of the phases in the framework is now the same for phases B, C, and D and focuses primarily on creating a Baseline and Target Architecture for that particular phase and everything that goes with it.

This seems to be a first step toward reversing the division that was previously thought to be necessary. Whether this will actually happen in the future remains to be seen.

The TAFIM phase called Implementation Planning is called Implementation Governance in the TOGAF Standard. From this perspective, the focus is on governance of the architecture work rather than pure planning. The part that focuses on planning is housed in the phase that precedes the governance phase, Migration Planning.

The phase in the TAFIM framework called SBA Administration – where SBA stands for Standards-Based Architecture – corresponds to Architecture Change Management on the TOGAF side. This phase manages changes to the architecture. It is designed to keep the architecture current and up to date.



Further Reading

The phases of the TAFIM framework are detailed in the document "Technical Architecture Framework for Information Management. Vol. 4. April 1996". They can be viewed at the URL below:

https://apps.dtic.mil/sti/pdfs/ADA321173.pdf

2.3. Summary

The emergence of architecture frameworks has been the catalyst for the creation and evolution of the TOGAF Standard as we know it today. The profession emerged in the 1960s and 1970s in response to the increasing complexity of IT environments and associated business processes.

One of the better-known frameworks is the Zachman Framework (actually an ontology). Published in 1987 by John Zachman, it was the first framework to focus on structuring IT infrastructure and business processes. In 1995, The Open Group introduced what is now called the TOGAF Standard, which provides a comprehensive approach to Enterprise Architecture.

The TOGAF Standard is derived from the TAFIM framework. The phases in the TAFIM framework are logically similar to the phases in the TOGAF Architecture Development Method, although they have evolved over the years.

In the mid- to late 2000s, Enterprise Architecture evolved to address the complexity of globalized and networked organizations. The focus shifted to a more holistic approach to Enterprise Architecture that included not only IT systems, but also business processes, people, and organizational structures. The evolution of Enterprise Architecture brought a new level of focus to the strategic importance of IT within organizations.

In the 2010s, Enterprise Architecture became an essential tool for guiding digital transformation initiatives, cloud adoption, and agile development practices. Throughout its history, Enterprise Architecture has evolved from a primarily IT-focused discipline to a strategic and business-centric practice.

Over the past few decades, the TOGAF Standard has matured from an enhanced version of the TAFIM framework to a full-fledged Enterprise Architecture framework, with the tenth edition released in 2022. A Technical Corrigendum was published in 2025 as a follow-up to the latest edition.